MicroRail

Game overview, feature catalogue and player feedback

Discussion edition: 15 October 2026 Current gameplay snapshot: 3bd2913 · Save format 41
Format: single-player desktop railway-management prototype

This document describes what can be played today and what may be added later. Future features are proposals for discussion, with no promised release dates. Please use the feature IDs when giving feedback.

1. The game we are building

MicroRail combines the dispatching and network-management appeal of Rail Route with the passenger and industry logistics of OpenTTD, presented as a readable, low-resolution railway game.

You build track, connect cities and industries, buy trains, define services and improve the railway as demand and operating problems emerge. The aim is a satisfying balance between building, watching trains run, solving bottlenecks and making business decisions. A small solo-project scope means that clarity and useful railway decisions take priority over simulating every possible transport system.

Core play loop: build a connection → assign trains → transport people or goods → understand delays and finances → improve the network → expand.

Cities already create passenger requests. Cities growing or shrinking in response to the railway is the next major direction, rather than an available feature today.

2. How to read the catalogue

- **C IDs — Current:** implemented in the prototype, subject to the limits described below.
- **N IDs — Next direction:** the immediate planned development focus.
- **F IDs — Future:** proposed additions or expansions; priority remains open to feedback.
- **D IDs — Deferred/outside core:** deliberately postponed, optional integrations or features outside the initial solo-project scope.

An existing feature may have a separate future extension. For example, automatic block signals exist now; advanced one-way signalling is future work. Similarly, station waiting satisfaction exists, but a full company reputation system does not.

3. Playable features today

3.1 Starting a game and exploring the map

ID	Feature	Available behaviour
C01	Tutorial and city sandbox	Choose the original three-station tutorial or an empty city sandbox from New Game. Introductory objectives exist; a full guided campaign does not.
C02	Reproducible city layouts	Enter a seed and choose 3–8 cities on an 80 × 50 flat map with four industry sites. Matching starts also depend on game/generator versions and settings.
C03	Player-built city stations	Place horizontal five-tile stations near cities, with a building/platform preview, catchment, population, cost and refusal explanation. One station belongs to one city in this first version.
C04	Camera and map navigation	Pan and zoom, use keyboard navigation with AZERTY/QWERTY support, and locate cities, facilities and trains through a minimap and search.
C05	Desktop display controls	A large resizable/maximized play area, optional fullscreen and a remappable fullscreen shortcut. Interface scaling is separate from map zoom.
C06	Simulation time	Pause or run at 1×, 2×, 5× or 10×, using a speed selector and remappable shortcuts. The clock shows game day and time.

3.2 Track construction and railway safety

ID	Feature	Available behaviour
C07	Mouse-based track laying	Connect or draw track with automatic straights, bends and diagonals. Extensions respect the original connection direction. Rotation shortcuts are unnecessary.
C08	Automatic and manual junctions	Build branches and merge onto existing track with automatic switch placement; a manual Switch tool and crossing geometry also exist.
C09	Demolition and construction costs	Drag-remove track; short right-click returns to Connect, while right-drag/hold removes track. Previews show costs/refunds, invalid placement and affected services.
C10	Draft construction and Undo/Redo	Plan multiple rail/switch/removal strokes before committing, inspect the total quote, and apply a validated group. Supported construction edits have grouped Undo/Redo. Station purchases are separate and not undoable.
C11	Shared-track reservations	Passenger and freight trains can share rails. Whole train bodies, occupied tiles and reserved track protect movement; switch locks remain until the tail clears.
C12	Signals and manual dispatch	Bidirectional automatic block signals, manual stop signals and train Hold/Resume controls are available. Corridor tools place or remove batches of signals.
C13	Deadlock detection and reversal	Detect sustained circular waits and inspect their causes. Reverse a train physically back toward its departure stop, retaining its load and position; recovery does not teleport it.
C14	Track damage and incomplete routes	A train keeps its physical position when its route is broken. It may continue if the break is behind it and the forward journey remains clear; warnings explain what needs repair.
C15	Passing loops and platforms	Waypoints and signal boundaries support configured passing loops. Compatible numbered platform sidings, measured lengths, fixed choices and Auto choices exist. Shuttle alternatives are checked before departure, not while approaching a platform.

3.3 Fleet and service operations

ID	Feature	Available behaviour
C16	Four locomotive models	Passenger Shuttle, Fast Passenger, Log Hauler and Heavy Log Hauler offer different purchase prices, capacities, speeds and running costs.
C17	Individual fleet management	Buy, name, sell, store, withdraw and replace trains. Permanent IDs identify vehicles; stored spares are off-map rather than using physical depot tracks.
C18	Separate train upgrades	Purchase speed and capacity upgrades independently, with separate prices. Upgrades belong to the vehicle, including when it is stored.
C19	Coaches and wagons	Attach up to four passenger coaches or log wagons. Capacity, length, speed limits and running cost change; platform fit and safe editing conditions are checked.
C20	Shuttle and Loop routes	Define ordered stops and choose a back-and-forth Shuttle or a closing Loop. Supported carriage routes include planned stop reversals and crossing figure-eights; arbitrary repeated track remains restricted.
C21	Waypoints and directives	Add ordered pass-through track cells per passenger leg and outward freight route, allowing a service to use a bypass without adding a station stop.
C22	Multiple passenger trains	Up to eight active passenger train/service instances in total, including linked ones, plus the current freight service. Trains can have independent routes or follow shared source instructions through linked services.
C23	Route editing and duplication	Copy instructions into a draft, duplicate a passenger service, drag-reorder stops, link/unlink instructions and keep independent train identities. Route geometry changes require safe physical starting conditions.
C24	Headway targets	Set a minimum origin-departure gap, measure actual gaps and see why a target may be unattainable. Linked trains share their group's headway.
C25	Departure timetables	Set daily departure times by passenger stop/direction, including returns and Loop closing legs. Linked trains share scheduled slots; missed departures and departure delays are measured.
C26	Arrival targets and guidance	Set optional directional arrival-time budgets and inspect punctuality, journey-time measurements and advisory feasibility ranges. These do not currently impose lateness fines or satisfaction penalties.
C27	Route identities	Saved route colours and short labels appear in editors, overlays and train badges. Individual train names are supported; custom locomotive paint schemes are not yet available.

3.4 Passengers, cities and station life

ID	Feature	Available behaviour
C28	City-owned trip supply	Fixed city populations generate requests for other cities, with larger destinations attracting more trips. Missing stations or unusable services produce unmet-demand measurements rather than passengers at unrelated stations.
C29	Destination queues and transfers	Passengers retain a final destination, can stay aboard through intermediate stops or change trains, and pay only at final delivery. Oldest eligible waiting groups board first.
C30	Local and Express demand	Local passengers accept stopping services and transfers. Express passengers need a direct next scheduled leg over a sufficiently distant journey. In the city model, every fourth eligible distant request expresses that preference.
C31	Differentiated fares	Current fixed fares are £5 per Local delivery and £10 per Express delivery. Receipts are recorded by class; the player cannot set fares yet.
C32	Station amenities and queue capacity	Buy a Shelter, Waiting room and Kiosk to improve waiting capacity, comfort and attractiveness. Train capacity upgrades do not themselves create passengers.
C33	Waiting satisfaction and demand response	Stations measure waiting experiences and comfort. Arrival attractiveness adjusts gradually; this is not yet a full reputation or end-to-end satisfaction system.
C34	Journey, occupancy and capacity feedback	View original journey elapsed times, recent completion summaries, seat utilisation and passengers left behind through lack of capacity. Some live diagnostics reset on load.
C35	City demand reports	Map labels show population. Station previews/inspectors and Find → City explain requests joining queues and requests blocked by missing stations, service, Express requirements or full queues.

3.5 Freight and the company economy

ID	Feature	Available behaviour
C36	Log transport	Produce logs at the forest, load a compatible freight train and deliver to the cargo terminal. Loading/departure rules, capacity and running costs apply.
C37	A complete processing chain	Optionally install a sawmill and factory: logs → timber → finished goods → terminal. Processing time, recipes, storage and physical deliveries determine output; intermediate transfers do not pay terminal revenue.
C38	Freight recovery and persistence	Freight cargo, production progress, inventories, train formation and recovery state survive loading. The current chain uses one freight shuttle/service.
C39	Company accounts	Track cash, passenger/freight income, construction spend, fleet costs and operating costs, with an Accounts breakdown and measured operating profit. Full historical business graphs are still planned.
C40	Bank loans	Borrow £1000, £2500 or £5000, one loan at a time. Fixed interest accrues, instalments are automatic, arrears are visible and early full repayment is possible.

3.6 Planning, feedback, interface and saves

ID	Feature	Available behaviour
C41	Direct inspection	Click a train/carriage, station or facility to inspect it; Inspect mode is also available. Train information distinguishes loading, timetable holds, traffic waits, route problems and deadlocks.
C42	Why-waiting diagnostics	See the blocker, physical footprint, requests/authority, reserved blocks and switch locks, with relevant actions such as locating the blocker, releasing a hold or reversing safely.
C43	Operational overlays	View service paths, signal blocks, hatched reservations and measured waiting hot spots. These display operational measurements, not guaranteed predictions of future traffic.
C44	Problems, incidents and alerts	Search current problems/history, filter severity, jump to locations and acknowledge conditions. Configurable notifications can pause or optionally slow high-speed play when qualifying incidents occur.
C45	Find and watchlists	Search trains, services, stations, cities and industries; filter, locate and pin objects in a session watchlist. Pins are not yet persistent across loading/exiting.
C46	Blueprints and local sharing	Capture reusable track/switch/signal layouts, search a local library and import/export validated JSON designs. Placement is priced and safety-checked; station blueprints, rotation and mirroring remain future extensions.
C47	Grouped interface	A grouped icon ribbon, compact status/Accounts, collapsible Map/Goals panels, readable tooltips, route badges and a branded title screen are implemented.
C48	Accessibility and controls	100–200% UI scaling, colour-blind-safe/high-contrast options, text/shapes/patterns alongside colour, reduced-motion settings and keyboard/mouse remapping. Full controller support is future work.
C49	Four manual save slots	Four independent games, a previous-save backup per slot, map/time/balance previews, Continue and explicit Load. New Game does not replace a saved file until Save is used.
C50	Reliable simulation and saves	Fixed simulation steps and saved RNG state support repeatability. Supported old saves migrate; invalid loads are rejected before replacing the current game. This is not a guarantee of cross-version replay compatibility.

4. Present limits and what feedback should take into account

- This is an evolving prototype, with placeholder/in-progress world artwork and a small stock/industry roster. The final appearance, soundscape, onboarding and balance are unfinished.
- City populations are fixed. The city sandbox starts with £5000; the tutorial starts with £1000 and its original stations/trains. A fresh city station normally costs £300 including five new rail tiles; a Passenger Shuttle costs £400. Values are provisional.
- There are 3–8 cities on one flat 80 × 50 map. Terrain, rivers, bridges and tunnels are not simulated yet. One station serves one city in the current catchment model.

- The active passenger-service limit includes linked instances. Freight currently has one service/shuttle and the initial log/timber/goods chain, rather than arbitrary cargo routes or a general freight network.
- Passing loops still need appropriate routes/waypoints, signal boundaries and sufficient clearance. Reservations do not make every layout deadlock-free or automatically choose every bypass.
- Auto platform changes are limited to supported choices and departure-time Shuttle checks. One-way signals, advanced automatic traffic priorities and in-motion arrival-platform switching are not available.
- Route/formation changes need safe starting conditions; there is no general moving-train route-editing system. Some repeated-path/long-consist combinations are refused.
- Historical diagnostic coverage varies: live waiting/occupancy measurements may reset on load, while saved journey, timetable, city-request and financial histories have their own bounded records.
- No periodic autosave, general scenario editor, mod loader, multiplayer or full rival railway AI is currently provided.

5. Immediate development direction

ID	Planned next step	Intended outcome
N01	Useful-service measurement	Combine actual completed passenger journeys with unmet city requests. Distinguish delivering people from merely filling a queue.
N02	Bounded city growth and decline	Let sustained useful service support growth and unmet demand support gradual decline, with grace periods and population floors. Preserve existing track, stations and accepted trips.
N03	Clear growth reasons and settings	Show trends and causes, with slower/no-growth choices. Extend the measured economy and later industry growth without presenting invisible or arbitrary penalties.

6. Future feature catalogue

6.1 Better operations and building tools

ID	Proposed feature	Intended gameplay benefit
F01	Advanced signalling	Add one-way, route and platform signal modes with clearer dispatch control and direction-aware recovery rules.
F02	Train priorities and fair dispatch	Let Express, Local and freight receive appropriate priorities and player overrides, while preventing starvation and retaining safe movement.
F03	Broader deadlock recovery	Offer more automatic turn-back, alternate routes and valid reversing locations; later include recovery locomotives and yard actions.
F04	Easier passing-loop routing	Help trains use suitable passing places while respecting deliberate waypoint choices; make shared station approaches easier to understand.
F05	Richer platform selection	Extend safe platform choice to more route situations, passenger preferences and potentially arrival-time changes; account for direction, length and transfer convenience.
F06	Directional and return waypoints	Add directional directives and independently controlled Shuttle return paths rather than automatically reversing the outward path.
F07	Wider repeated-path support	Broaden supported train-body geometry beyond the current loops, planned reversals and crossing figure-eights.
F08	Deferred service edits	Apply route/formation changes after a trip or at a suitable depot, without moving trains unexpectedly or interrupting accepted journeys.
F09	Fleet automation and comparison	Compare compatible vehicles, save formation templates and optionally automate replacement or capacity increases with visible costs.
F10	Better planning and path advice	Recommend routes with estimated cost/time, itemise more construction costs and flag evidence-based single-track bottlenecks and affected services.
F11	Expanded corridor tools	Add double-tracking, speed upgrades, electrification and platform batches when their underlying systems exist.
F12	Richer blueprints	Include compatible stations/platforms, rotation, mirroring, tags and footprint/cost thumbnail previews.
F13	More persistent search and alerts	Keep watchlists/presets across sessions and refine actionable notification filtering and operational labels.

6.2 Passenger demand and service quality

ID	Proposed feature	Intended gameplay benefit
F14	Timed transfers and holding rules	Wait for connections or a target load within a maximum waiting window, and explain missed connections and knock-on delays.
F15	More complete scheduling	Extend headway controls and arrival planning, with appropriate service-quality consequences and transparent feasibility guidance.
F16	Richer passenger preferences	Gradually add business, tourist and budget priorities alongside commuters/Express, with understandable choices around frequency, comfort, scenery and punctuality.
F17	Fare controls and elasticity	Set service/class fares or off-peak discounts and see how prices affect demand and revenue.
F18	Full company reputation	Extend waiting satisfaction into documented journey, punctuality and crowding scoring, unlocking stronger demand, contracts or subsidies.
F19	Demand and bottleneck adviser	Estimate future queues, platform demand and shortages using measured history, with clickable evidence and clearly labelled forecasts.
F20	Wider catchments and feeder access	Show walking access, workplaces and competing stations; support several stations per city with explicit allocation and abstract bus/tram/park-and-ride feeders.
F21	Detailed station life	Draw waiting pixel passengers and boarding activity from actual queue counts, grouping sprites for performance.
F22	Expanded passenger facilities	Add priced improvements for loading/dwell and service quality beyond existing shelters, waiting rooms, kiosks and platform geometry.

6.3 Freight, industry and business

ID	Proposed feature	Intended gameplay benefit
F23	General cargo networks	Expand the first processing chain into more industries/recipes and independent freight routes/services.
F24	Special cargo behaviour	Add perishables, hazardous loads and high-value express freight with visible spoilage, handling, speed or delivery requirements.
F25	Mail and parcels	Carry smaller high-value consignments, possibly in compatible passenger formations with explicit shared capacity.
F26	More rolling stock	Add coach classes, boxcars, tankers, hoppers and flatcars with distinct suitability, loading rates and capacity.
F27	Freight and energy facilities	Build warehouses, handling upgrades and, when locomotive energy is modelled, fuel facilities.
F28	Delivery contracts	Accept quantities/deadlines with clear rewards and failure terms; connect punctuality to contract payouts when that system is ready.
F29	Industry growth	Let useful supply and deliveries support bounded production/industry expansion, preserving recipe and storage accounting.
F30	Marketing and public-service support	Offer temporary promotion, subsidies or regional obligations with stated frequency/fare requirements and penalties.
F31	Deeper operating budgets	Separate fuel/energy, maintenance, workforce, station upkeep, interest and penalties as those costs become real systems.
F32	Expanded finance	Add variable lenders/rates, forecasts and insolvency rules; extend the existing fixed-rate loan system carefully.
F33	Leasing and used vehicles	Trade lower upfront costs against leasing terms, condition, reliability and operating expenses.
F34	Land and transit rights	Buy access or land before expansion makes it expensive; integrate ownership with construction previews.
F35	Limited rival bidding	Consider competition for industry rights or territory once contracts/land systems are stable. This is separate from full railway-building AI.
F36	Factual company journal	Turn real incidents and shipments into bounded headlines and optional passenger/cargo stories without obscuring operational logs.

6.4 Infrastructure and maintenance

ID	Proposed feature	Intended gameplay benefit
F37	Terrain, bridges and tunnels	Weigh grades, construction cost and route distance; introduce infrastructure challenges beyond the flat map.
F38	Rivers, regions and landmarks	Create recognisable countryside, Alpine, Nordic, desert, tropical or urban settings with meaningful crossings and optional regional differences.
F39	Depots and stabling	Provide physical spare-train storage, layovers and cleaning away from running lines, with capacity and safe access.
F40	Maintenance yards and breakdowns	Add condition, servicing visits, warnings, repairs and possible temporary bottlenecks. Mechanical penalties should be adjustable, including no-breakdown play.
F41	Track wear, rail classes and weight limits	Make heavy trains and stronger rail a maintenance/cost choice, with visible conditions and routing constraints.
F42	Work zones and slow orders	Apply temporary, explained speed restrictions for works, damage or supported weather effects.
F43	Optional workforce abstraction	Merge crew/staff ideas into one mostly automatic system affecting cost, fatigue, skills and service quality, without detailed personal rosters.
F44	Shunting and yard operations	Split/merge formations, reverse at suitable facilities and operate depot/recovery movements where these create useful decisions.

6.5 Progression and a changing world

ID	Proposed feature	Intended gameplay benefit
F45	Historical eras and electrification	Progress from steam to diesel to electric, with infrastructure and operating trade-offs; electric trains need suitable wired routes.
F46	Research and technology	Use one coherent unlock system for signalling, track speed, locomotives and cargo handling, with optional time/investment progression.
F47	Weather and seasons	Add rain, snow and autumn appearance; optional operational effects follow actual terrain/traction systems and clear forecasts.
F48	Day/night lighting	Add station lights and headlamps while keeping signals readable; operational night restrictions remain optional.
F49	Valuation, milestones and sustainability	Measure company value, passenger/freight movement and service quality; consider optional era-aware environmental goals.
F50	Dynamic disruptions and surges	Introduce closures, temporary demand spikes and events with clear durations, recovery conditions and adjustable frequency.

6.6 Presentation, spectators and community

ID	Proposed feature	Intended gameplay benefit
F51	Finished low-resolution art	Refine world/building/train assets and animation into a consistent visual style; toolbar graphics are already partly integrated.
F52	Custom liveries and cosmetic rewards	Paint fleets with selectable palettes; keep operational labels readable and basic palettes freely available. Unlock extra liveries/themes through achievements.
F53	Railway soundscape	Add locomotive horns, rail sounds, station announcements and ambient audio, with volume controls and visual alternatives for important cues.
F54	Train-follow and spectator cameras	Follow a train, watch a station or use a minimal-UI ride-along view, with an easy return to building controls.
F55	Richer overview and statistics	Add measured traffic-density views and historical company/route graphs for profit, ridership, occupancy, delays and incidents.
F56	Photo mode and local sharing	Export screenshots with optional route/train overlays and selectable interface visibility. Posting externally remains a deliberate player action.
F57	Recent visual replay	Watch a bounded recent history, approximately ten simulation minutes, and revisit incidents. Visual replay is distinct from undo, rollback and deterministic replay.
F58	Full procedural terrain settings	Expand seeded starts to adjustable map size, rivers, terrain and resource/industry density. Share versions/rules with seeds for reproducibility.
F59	Level and scenario editor	Create maps, industries, objectives and delivery challenges, starting with validated local import/export and forum sharing.
F60	Lightweight modding	Support documented scenario, sprite and cargo/vehicle data packs, with clear compatibility checks.
F61	Town names, lore and regional stories	Add player town renaming, editable local histories, industry flavour and regional needs without requiring an online generative service.
F62	Tourism and railway heritage	Offer optional scenic, seasonal, royal/military or preservation scenarios, special services, an encyclopedia/museum and cosmetic trophies.

6.7 Modes, learning, accessibility and longevity

ID	Proposed feature	Intended gameplay benefit
F63	Guided tutorial campaigns	Teach track, stations, signals, transfers, contracts, incidents and growth one system at a time, with repeatable/skippable lessons and contextual help.
F64	Sandbox and difficulty modifiers	Add unlimited money, slower/no growth, cost/contract pressure and optional no-pause rules. Maintenance/weather/event controls arrive with those mechanics.
F65	Scenario packs and challenges	Combine low cash, track budgets, single-track restrictions or punctuality goals with achievable objectives and explicit scoring.
F66	Achievements and cosmetic unlocks	Reward measurable goals such as efficient town connections or on-time deliveries, with optional platform achievements and extra cosmetic themes.
F67	Shared seeds and asynchronous competition	Share runs, campaign medals and results manually first; consider daily/weekly challenges after formats are stable.
F68	Ghost networks and benchmarks	Compare layouts or construction/performance histories. Executable deterministic replays need additional recording and verification beyond existing logs.
F69	Controller and Steam Deck support	Add stable focus/navigation, suitable menus and possibly radial controls once the core interface settles.
F70	Periodic rotating autosaves	Add bounded automatic save rotation and recovery while keeping the existing four manual games and their backups safe.

7. Deliberately deferred or outside the core release scope

ID	Feature	Current scope decision
D01	Detailed electric power grids	Defer substations, distribution and load management. Basic route electrification is the earlier goal.
D02	Insurance and detailed disaster finance	Defer; basic incident repair/recovery remains in the maintenance direction.
D03	Airports and operating ferries	Outside the initial railway scope. Ports/intermodal facilities may instead act as rail cargo origins or destinations.
D04	Cooperative multiplayer	Outside core scope until simulation, saves, commands and networking rules are proven; the current foundations are not a multiplayer promise.
D05	Full competitor railway-building AI	Defer. Limited bids/rights competition is the smaller possible future mechanic.
D06	Detailed staff rostering	Defer personal shifts/rosters in favour of the single optional workforce abstraction.
D07	Cinematic scripting and video exports	Defer video/GIF/time-lapse export and elaborate camera scripting; photo tools and visual replay are earlier candidates.
D08	Hosted leaderboards and Steam Workshop	Optional later integrations after local sharing/challenge formats work. They are not required for the base editor or game.

8. Feedback we would like from players

You do not need to be a railway expert or a programmer. Comments about confusion, enjoyment, pace and things you would remove are as useful as new feature suggestions.

8.1 Quick response form

Copy this section into your reply, or send it as a separate document.

- **Name or nickname (optional):**
- **Experience with railway/transport games:** new / occasional / experienced
- **Have you played this prototype?** yes / no; if yes, give build/commit, mode and approximate time played.
- **What most appeals to you about the concept?**
- **Your five highest-priority future features:** list N/F IDs in order, with a short reason.
- **Three features you would postpone or remove:** list IDs and reasons.
- **Preferred emphasis:** network dispatch / open-ended building / passenger service / freight logistics / business strategy / watching trains / a mixture.
- **Preferred complexity:** relaxed / balanced / demanding. Which systems should always be optional?
- **What would make you return after the first session?**

8.2 Questions for people who have played

1. Was it clear how to build stations/track and start the first useful service? Where did you get stuck?

2. When a train waited, could you understand the cause and find a useful action? Give a specific example.

3. Were passing loops, signals, waypoints and platform choices understandable? What explanation or preview was missing?

4. Could you distinguish a Shuttle from a Loop and independent routes from linked trains?

5. Did city population, trip requests and unmet-demand reports explain where passengers came from? Was 'joined queue' clearly different from 'delivered'?

6. Did the first network feel affordable? Which costs, fares or upgrade choices felt too generous or too restrictive?

7. Did schedules, headways, arrival targets and passenger classes create interesting decisions or extra administration?

8. How readable were the toolbar, map, inspectors and alerts at your screen size/UI scale? Were any cues dependent on colour or hard to operate?

9. Did 1×/2×/5×/10×, pause and incident notifications provide the control you wanted?

10. What was your most satisfying moment, and your biggest frustration?

8.3 Questions about the future direction

1. Should city growth reward frequent, reliable, completed journeys, broad destination coverage, low fares, or another measure? What would feel unfair?

2. Would you enjoy maintenance and breakdowns? What warning/recovery options and relaxed settings would you need?

3. Would terrain, bridges/tunnels and historical electrification add more value than a larger cargo or locomotive roster?

4. Is deeper finance/reputation attractive, or would it distract from the railway?

5. Would you primarily play sandbox, hand-crafted scenarios, seeded challenges or an introductory campaign?

6. How much priority should art, sound, station crowds, custom liveries and spectator cameras receive compared with new management systems?

7. Would you create or share blueprints, scenarios or data/asset mods? Which sharing format would you actually use?

8. What important railway decision is missing? If you add a feature, suggest one existing proposal it could replace or postpone.

8.4 Reporting a reproducible problem

Please include the build/commit, tutorial/city mode, seed and city count where relevant, simulation speed, steps to reproduce, expected/actual behaviour and the exact inspector message. A screenshot or save file helps if available. Do not include personal information you do not want shared.

For each suggestion, this format is useful: **Feature ID → problem or benefit → proposed change → priority (must/should/could) → complexity you would accept.**

9. Project context and document scope

MicroRail currently uses Godot and GDScript. The design favours a reliable simulation, safe saves, accessible controls and a small coherent railway game. Low-resolution artwork and animation are being prepared; their presence in planning does not imply that every visual set is integrated.

This edition is a discussion snapshot, checked against the current implementation and feature documentation. Older roadmap paragraphs sometimes describe earlier stages; this catalogue uses current behaviour for linked services, platform choices, schedules and city demand. Future priorities can change after feedback, and no purchase, distribution, release-date or multiplayer commitment is implied.

Developer reference: development roadmap, starting a game, city demand, platforms, route copying/linked trains, timetables and save guarantees.